By the end of the millennium, INDIA TODAY **was documenting how** social and economic change had begun to shape the most private aspects of Indian life—bodies, homes and relationships.

Ageing ceased to be taken for granted. It was monitored, corrected and deferred through clinics, supplements and cosmetic intervention. Beauty parlours gave way to medicalised fixes; surgery lost its stigma. The body became something to be worked on. Male virility, too, came under scrutiny, as stress and performance anxiety followed success into the bedroom.

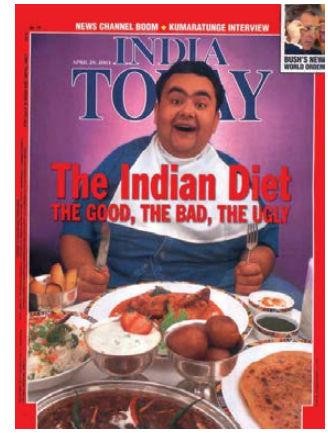
At home, parenting grew anxious and deliberate. Children were assessed early, their intelligence and behaviour tracked. Play turned purposeful; manuals displaced instinct. Love remained, but certainty did not.

Money arrived earlier and was spent faster. Call centres reshaped ambition and sleep. Imported goods made aspiration affordable; credit replaced waiting. Technology unsettled as much as it enabled—Y2K exposed fragile systems, while mobile phones compressed intimacy and thinned privacy.

Food lost its certainties, illness struck earlier, and spirituality repackaged itself as wellness. And beneath the surface, harder stories persisted: trafficked children, traded wildlife and the missing girl child—evidence that prosperity had not erased prejudice, only refined it. ■



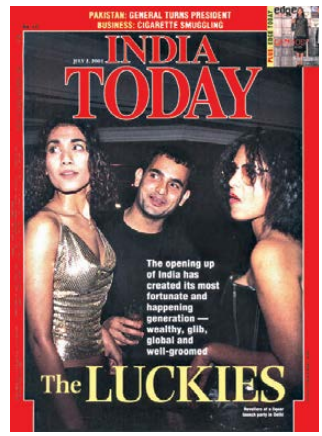
▲ Apr. 27, 1998



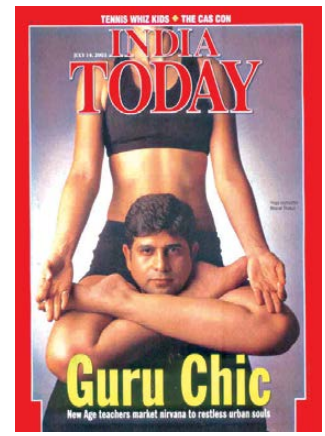
▲ Apr. 28, 2003



▲ May 7, 2001



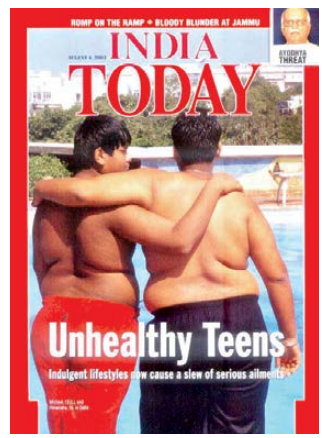
▲ Jul. 2, 2001



▲ Jul. 14, 2003



▲ Jul. 21, 1997



▲ Aug. 4, 2003



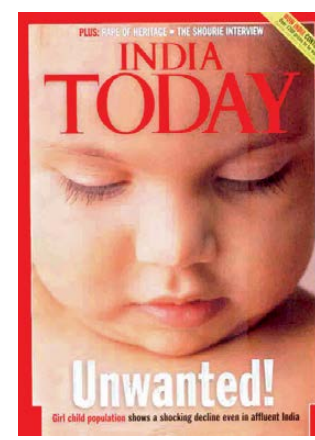
▲ Oct. 6, 2003



▲ Oct. 14, 2002



▲ Nov. 2, 1998



▲ Nov. 10, 2003